

Marcin Banasiak



Bio

Marcin Banasiak — cinematographer and documentary director, **Fulbright** scholar, creator of **award-winning** films and AI projects, **decorated** for humanitarian work in Ukraine.

His films have been presented and awarded at prestigious festivals, including **Seattle International Film Festival**, **Santa Barbara IFF**, **Polish Film Festival in Gdynia**, and the **International Documentary Film Festival in Kyiv**. He has collaborated on productions in Poland, the USA, Serbia, Nigeria, and China, creating fiction films, documentaries, commercials, and music projects for brands such as **Maserati**, **AMD** and **Evil Geniuses**.

In recent years, he has also been developing original documentary projects, including the film **Surzhyk** (in production), which was accompanied by a photo album and exhibition (Surzhyk. War Photographs from Eastern Ukraine, **Freedom Games 2022**). He has been intensively exploring the possibilities of artificial intelligence in film art, creating projects such as *70 Moments*, *Polestar - Silence That Moves You*, *Man of Glass*, and *Dreamy Forest*.



Bio

An important element of his social activity has been education — in 2019, he taught cinematography in Lagos as part of the Del-York Creative Academy program, supporting the development of young filmmakers in Nigeria. After the outbreak of the full-scale war in Ukraine in 2022, he became involved in **humanitarian work** in frontline and liberated areas of the Kharkiv region. He collaborated with the Ukrainian foundation Unity and Strength and co-founded the Koper Pomaga foundation in Poland. For his work, he was **awarded the medals** "Volunteer Courage" (from the military commander of the Kharkiv region) and "For Dignity and Patriotism" (from the International Legion in Ukraine).

He is a graduate of the **American Film Institute Conservatory** in Los Angeles (MFA, 2017), where he studied cinematography as a **Fulbright** scholar. Previously, he completed the **Krzysztof Kieślowski Film School in Katowice (2013)** and the **Łódź University of Technology** in Computer Science (2007).



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Sin Cielo

Short, USA 2018,
dir. Jianna Maarten Saada — cinematographer



Set on the borderlands between Mexico and the USA, two teenagers experience first love in a world where violence seems inevitable. The film combines intimate narrative with a realistic portrayal of life on the border.

The film won the Grand Jury Prize at Seattle International Film Festival (2018, an Oscar-qualifying festival) and awards at the Ivy Film Festival (Audience Award + Jury Award) and Santa Barbara International Film Festival (2019, Bruce Corwin Award). It was also presented at Palm Springs ShortFest and LA Film Festival.

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When the Lights of Dawn Arise

Short, Poland 2012,
dir. Mateusz Głowacki — cinematographer



The 1960s. Poland. A company outing goes by bus to pick mushrooms. The director announces a contest: whoever finds the biggest mushroom will receive a bonus. It quickly becomes apparent that for the participants, pleasing the boss is more important than the mushrooms themselves.

The film won the Jury Prize for Best Film in the "Young Polish Cinema" competition at the Polish Film Festival in Gdynia (2012) and over a dozen other distinctions, including Grand Prix "Offelia" at Offeliada (2013), "Jańcio Wodnik" at Prowincjonalia (2013), Grand Prix at CK OFF in Przemyśl (2014), and Best Film Award at the Best Off festival (2014).

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Survey About Men

Documentary short, Poland 2013,
dir. M. Głowacki — Cinematographer
(together with Kacper Sędziewski).



This film is a record of street interviews with men of various ages and from different backgrounds, who answer questions about life, values, love, and everyday life. A mosaic of male experiences and perspectives emerges from simple conversations.

The film won the Grand Prix at the International Documentary Film Festival in Kyiv (2013) and many other awards, including 3rd prize at the "Dwa Brzegi" Festival (2013), Grand Prix at MFFN "Publicystyka" in Kędzierzyn-Koźle, Audience Award at Short Waves (2014), and Grand Prix at ProFiRe Film Festival in Edinburgh (2014).

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His Mother

Short, USA 2019,
dir. Dawid Krepski — Cinematographer



An arthouse thriller about single motherhood. The story of an immigrant and aspiring actress in Los Angeles, whose life seems ordinary on the surface. Gradually, however, it is revealed that she has been exploited and isolated from the world, and beneath the surface of her daily life lies something dark and disturbing.

The film won the **Filmmaker Award 2020** for **Outstanding Short Film (Experimental/Arthouse)** and was presented at **Oscar-qualifying** festivals, including **HollyShorts (2020)** and **Rhode Island International Film Festival (2020)**.

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The Allnighter

Feature film, USA 2023,
dir. Aimee Graham — Cinematographer.



The story of an astrophysics doctoral student who loses his invaluable research due to a car theft. To recover it, he enters into a risky deal with a mysterious woman who runs a pawn shop. The film combines elements of comedy-drama and independent cinema with the atmosphere of an urban story about ambition and risk.

The film was presented at independent festivals in the USA, including in Los Angeles and Palm Springs.

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Polestar -Silence That Moves You

AI commercial film Poland 2025
director, concept creator.

A promotional film created entirely using generative artificial intelligence tools. The project was a visual experiment aimed at presenting the Polestar brand in a new, futuristic aesthetic, impossible to achieve through traditional filmmaking methods.

Polestar combines advertising language with an artistic approach to image, showcasing the potential of AI in commercial creation and visual storytelling.

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Maserati - Perception

Commercial, USA 2019,
dir. Timon Birkhofer — Cinematographer.

A dynamic and stylish film promoting the Maserati brand, based on modern visual language and created by an international team of creators. The project combines the elegance of the brand with bold cinematographic solutions, emphasizing the character of the car as a symbol of prestige and speed.

The film was part of Maserati's global campaign and was presented in industry media and the brand's promotional channels.

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70 chwil

AI short Poland 2024
director, creator.

An experimental project created using generative artificial intelligence. The film was based on archival photographs that were animated and processed, creating a new, poetic visual narrative.

70 Moments is an attempt to grapple with memory and the ephemerality of images — bringing together history recorded in photographs and history recorded in photographs with the possibilities of contemporary digital tools.

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Surżyk

Film dokumentalny (w realizacji), Polska/Ukraina
wystawa fotograficzna, Poland 2022; photo album,
Poland 2022 — director, cinematographer.

The project tells the story of ordinary people affected by war in Ukraine. It's the story of those who stayed. The documentary film (in production) follows the lives of five protagonists in various locations, showing the drama of everyday life against the backdrop of conflict. In parallel, a photo exhibition was created: Surzhyk. War Photographs from Eastern Ukraine (Freedom Games, Łódź 2022) as well as a photo album Surzhyk (published December 2022).

The project combines visual forms — film, photography, and artistic narrative — creating a cohesive record of the war experience in eastern Ukraine.

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Other Projects



More About Me

I spend half the year in a van – it's my way to freedom, being close to nature, and working on the road. I feel best in the mountains because I'm a passionate climber and nature lover.

When I'm not climbing rocks, I'm usually riding my bike somewhere, drinking another coffee, or... snacking on sweets, to which I unfortunately have a weakness.

I love the history and culture of Spain – I always gladly return to it. And lately, I've been learning to play chess. Rather painfully. I speak several languages: English and Russian fluently, Spanish and Ukrainian well, a bit of German, and very poorly French.

